The Power of Proverbs

Acting First

The early bird catches the worm — moving first gives you the best chance.

First come, first served — the person who arrives first gets the place.

You snooze, you lose — if you wait too long, you miss your chance.

Strike while the iron is hot — act now, while the moment is good.

Planning and Risk

Don't count your chickens before they hatch — don't plan on good news too soon.

Don't put all your eggs in one basket — don't risk everything on one plan.

Better safe than sorry — it is wiser to be careful now than to regret later.

Look before you leap — check the risks before you jump into something.

Judging and Comparing

Don't judge a book by its cover — looks can be misleading.

The grass is always greener on the other side — other lives look better.

Actions speak louder than words — what people do matters more than words.

It takes two to tango — in an argument, both people share the blame.

Time and Effort

Rome wasn't built in a day — big things take time and patience.

Time flies when you're having fun — good times seem to pass quickly.

No use crying over spilt milk — don't stay upset about what already happened.

What goes around comes around — how you treat others comes back to you.

Discussion

Which of these proverbs do you actually use? Which sound old-fashioned?

Is the early bird always right? When is waiting smarter than rushing?

Tell us about a time you counted your chickens a little too soon.

"Don't put all your eggs in one basket" — what are your baskets right now?

Have you ever judged a book by its cover and been wrong? What happened?

Why do other people's lives always look greener on the other side?

Do you know someone whose actions speak louder than their words?

What have you been building slowly, like Rome? Are you still at it?

When did time fly for you this year? What were you doing?

What is spilt milk in your life — something you had to stop crying over?

Do you believe "what goes around comes around"? Give a real example.

Would you rather be safe than sorry, or take a big risk? Why?

Which proverb would you teach a child first, and why?

Do proverbs still help people, or are they just old sayings?